

overview

Frameworks

Marketing
Strategy-1

Marketing
Strategy-2

Marketing
Strategy-3

Engagement
Metrics

PRODUCT CLUB SUMMER PROJECT

RCA: Decoding Product Success & Failure

From Problems to Product Thinking

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INTRO TO PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

Product Management includes a wide range of responsibilities that vary across industries and Companies, but the Core principle remains consistent solving for users in the simplest and most effective manner while operating within business constraints.

Visionary Leader + Techie + Strategic Thinker + User Advocate = Exceptional Product Manager

What is Product Management?

Product management is a cross-functional role that lies at the confluence of technology, sales & marketing, and business. A PM wholly owns the product and works directly with the senior executives (C-suits) and the customers. A PM is the only advocate who represents the customers in a company and makes sure every decision contains a customer perspective too.



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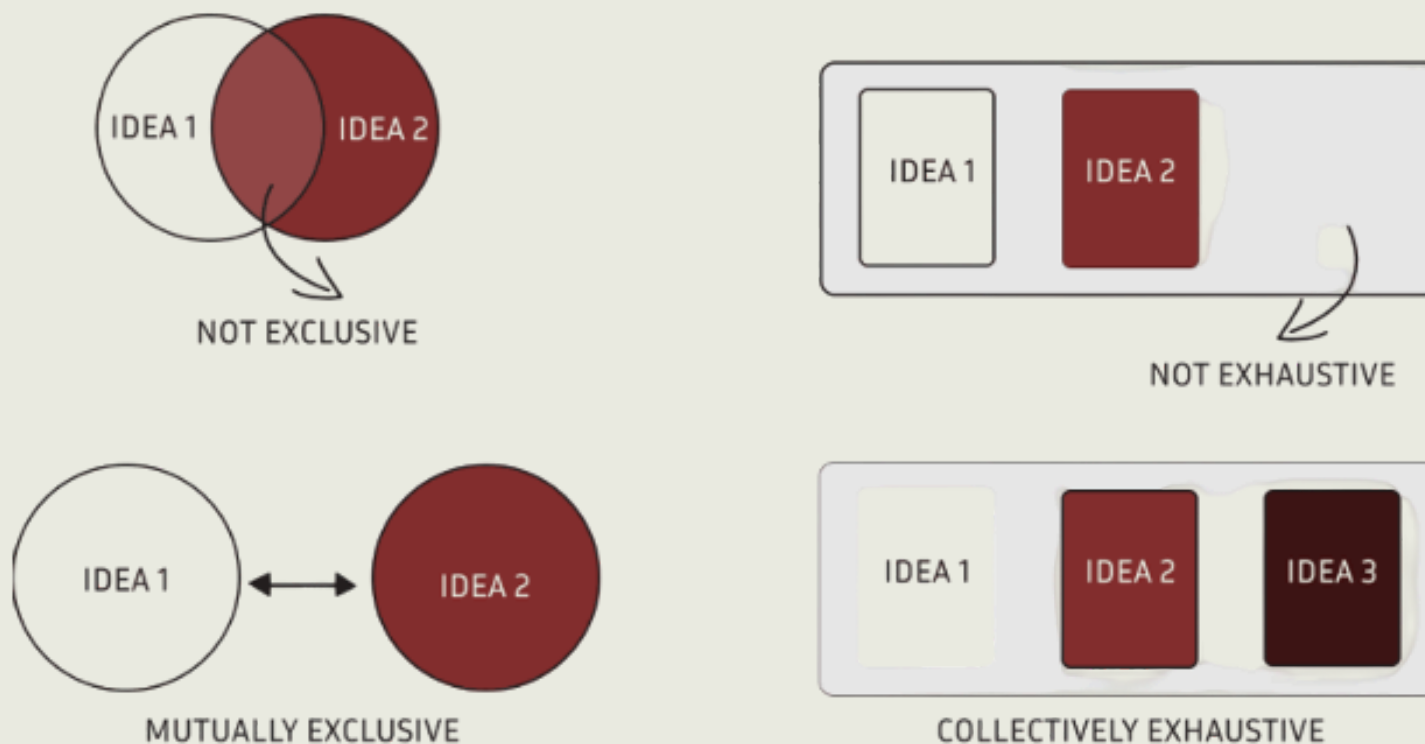
RCA FRAMEWORKS

Mutually Exclusive Collectively Exhaustive (MECE)

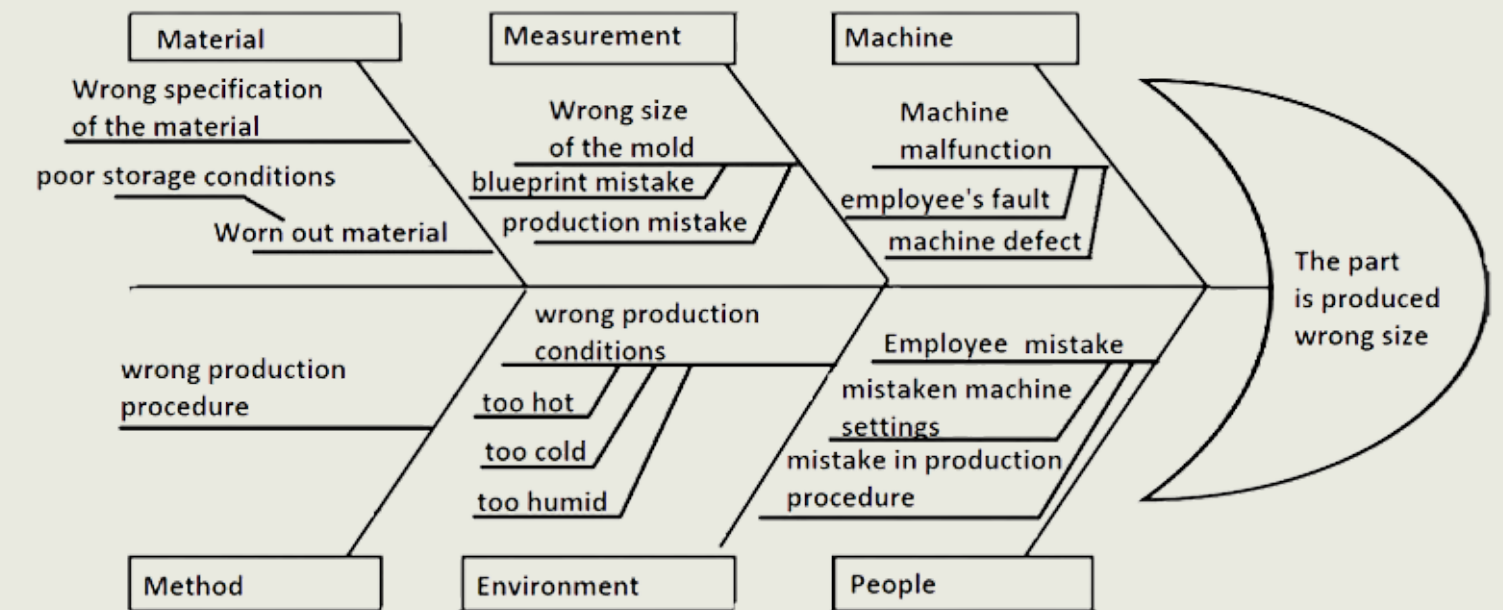
MECE is made up of two parts. First, “mutually exclusive” is a concept from probability theory that says two events cannot occur simultaneously. Second, “collectively exhaustive” means that the set of ideas includes all possible options.

MECE

(Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive)



Fishbone Diagram



Also called the Ishikawa diagram or cause-and-effect diagram, this tool helps identify, explore, and visually display all possible causes of a specific problem, not just the most obvious ones.

It is shaped like a fish:

The "head" is the problem statement (effect).

The "bones" are the major cause.

Smaller bones branch off with sub-causes.

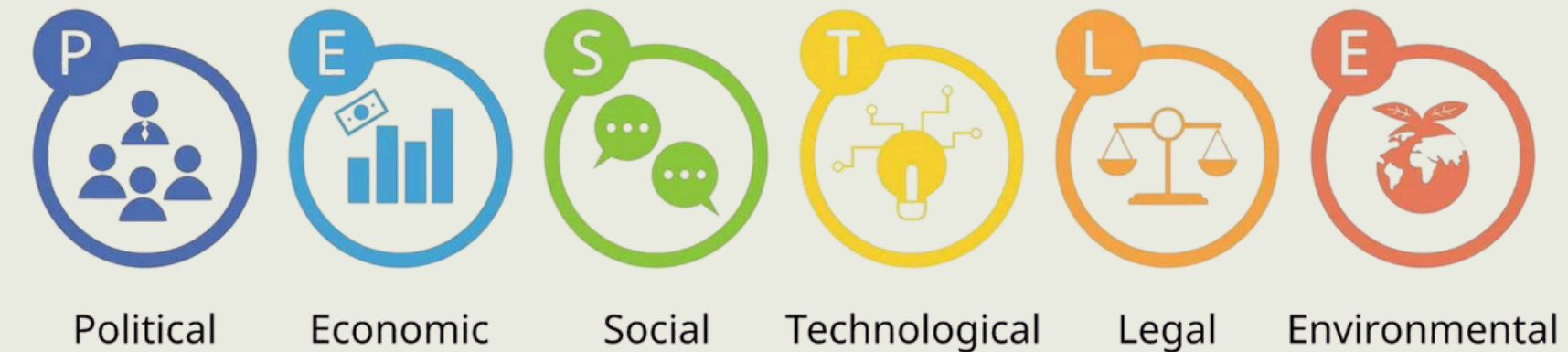
5 WHYS

The 5 Whys is a Root Cause Analysis (RCA) technique used to uncover the underlying cause of a problem by repeatedly asking "Why?". The idea is that by the fifth "Why", you will reach the root cause of most problems. However, you may need to ask more or fewer than five questions depending on complexity.

Steps to Apply 5 Whys

- Clearly state the problem.
- Ask "Why did this happen?"
- Record the answer.
- Use the answer as the basis for the next "Why."
- Repeat until you find the fundamental root cause.

PESTEL Analysis



It is a strategic framework used to analyze **macro-environmental factors**.

- **Political**-Government policies, trade restrictions, tax reforms, stability.
- **Economic**- Inflation, interest rates, purchasing power, unemployment.
- **Social**- Cultural trends, demographics, education, lifestyle changes.
- **Technological**- Innovation, R&D, adoption rates, digital infrastructure.
- **Environmental**- Climate change, carbon footprint, sustainability expectations.
- **Social**- Regulations, consumer rights, data protection laws.

SWOT

What's in a SWOT analysis?

Strengths (internal, positive)

Weaknesses (internal, negative)

Opportunities (external, positive)

Threats (external, negative)

The good

The not-so-good

What we've got

Strengths

What resources can we deploy?
What are our advantages?
What's working well?



Weaknesses

What abilities are we lacking?
Where are we starting to struggle?
How can we overcome these?



What's out there

Opportunities

Who might most value our strengths?
What trends work in our favour?
What prizes are within reach?



Threats

What headwinds do we face?
Who might challenge us?
What could go wrong?



It is a strategic planning tool used to evaluate a product, company, or situation to make informed decisions and uncover both advantages and risks.

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4Ps

Product

What you're offering to customers — goods or services.

Focus: features, quality, design, brand, lifecycle.

Price

How much customers pay for the product.

Focus: pricing strategy, discounts, perceived value, competitive pricing.

Place

How the product is distributed and where it's available.

Focus: channels (online/offline), logistics, coverage, accessibility.

Promotion

How you communicate and persuade customers to buy.

Focus: advertising, sales promotions, PR, digital marketing.

JTBD Framework

Purpose:

JTBD helps you understand why customers "hire" a product — not just what it does, but the outcome they want.

Core Idea:

Customers don't buy products; they hire them to get a job done.

Three Dimensions of a Job:

Functional: What task do they want to complete?

Emotional: How do they want to feel?

Social: How do they want to be perceived?

Google Stadia RCA (Root Cause Analysis)

Overview:

- Cloud gaming service launched in Nov 2019, discontinued in Jan 2023.
- Promised 4K/60 FPS gaming via cloud, but faced adoption challenges.

Key Issues Identified:

- Limited game library & lack of exclusives.
- High dependency on stable, high-speed internet.
- Streaming quality issues (input lag, 4K upscaling from 1080p).
- Unclear subscription value – users still had to buy games.
- Poor device support and UX flaws (missing features, confusing controller setup).
- Market trust issues due to Google's history of discontinuing products.

User Feedback Highlights:

- Gameplay quality was hindered by input latency, especially in fast-paced games
- Streaming quality fell short of expectations, with most games being upscaled from 1080p rather than true 4K.
- The platform felt incomplete and lacked refinement, giving the impression of a premature launch.
- A limited content library and lack of social features reduced its competitive appeal.

Root Cause: Weak content ecosystem, immature execution, and technical constraints undermined user trust and adoption despite strong cloud infrastructure.

Link for the Docs: <https://medium.com/@pmgroupiitk/product-teardown-google-stadia-da439d431584>

WHAT IS A MARKETING STRATEGY?

A marketing strategy can sway consumers to buy a particular company's products or services. It may include multiple marketing ideas for each of the firm's sectors or product lines.

Marketing Strategy vs. Marketing Plan

Aspect	Marketing Strategy	Marketing Plan
Definition	High-level vision and approach to achieve goals	Tactical roadmap of actions to execute the strategy
Focus	Why and what	How, when, where, and who
Scope	Long-term, big picture	Short- to mid-term, detailed
Includes	- Target audience- Value proposition- Positioning	- Campaign timelines- Channels- Budget- KPIs
Example	“Position our app as the #1 wellness solution for Gen Z”	“Launch TikTok ads in Q3 targeting students, \$50k budget”

AAMCHI HOCCO ICE CREAM – MARKETING EXAMPLE

BRAND POSITIONING	"Premium ice cream with local soul."
Key Strategy	-Combine premium product quality with regional identity (Gujarati roots) -Leverage nostalgia, authenticity, and local pride.
Marketing Tactics	Regional Branding Visual Identity & Packaging Storytelling & Legacy Modern Touchpoints
Target Audience	-Millennials and Gen Z in urban India -Conscious consumers who value local, premium, and authentic experiences.

Marketing: Assessment

- Marketing Research vs. Market Research



4 Ps

New Product Development
Pricing Strategies
Channel Strategies
Promotional Activities
Advertising
Sales
Public Relations



Place

Customer Information
Competition
External Environment
Market Demand & Supply
Emerging Trends

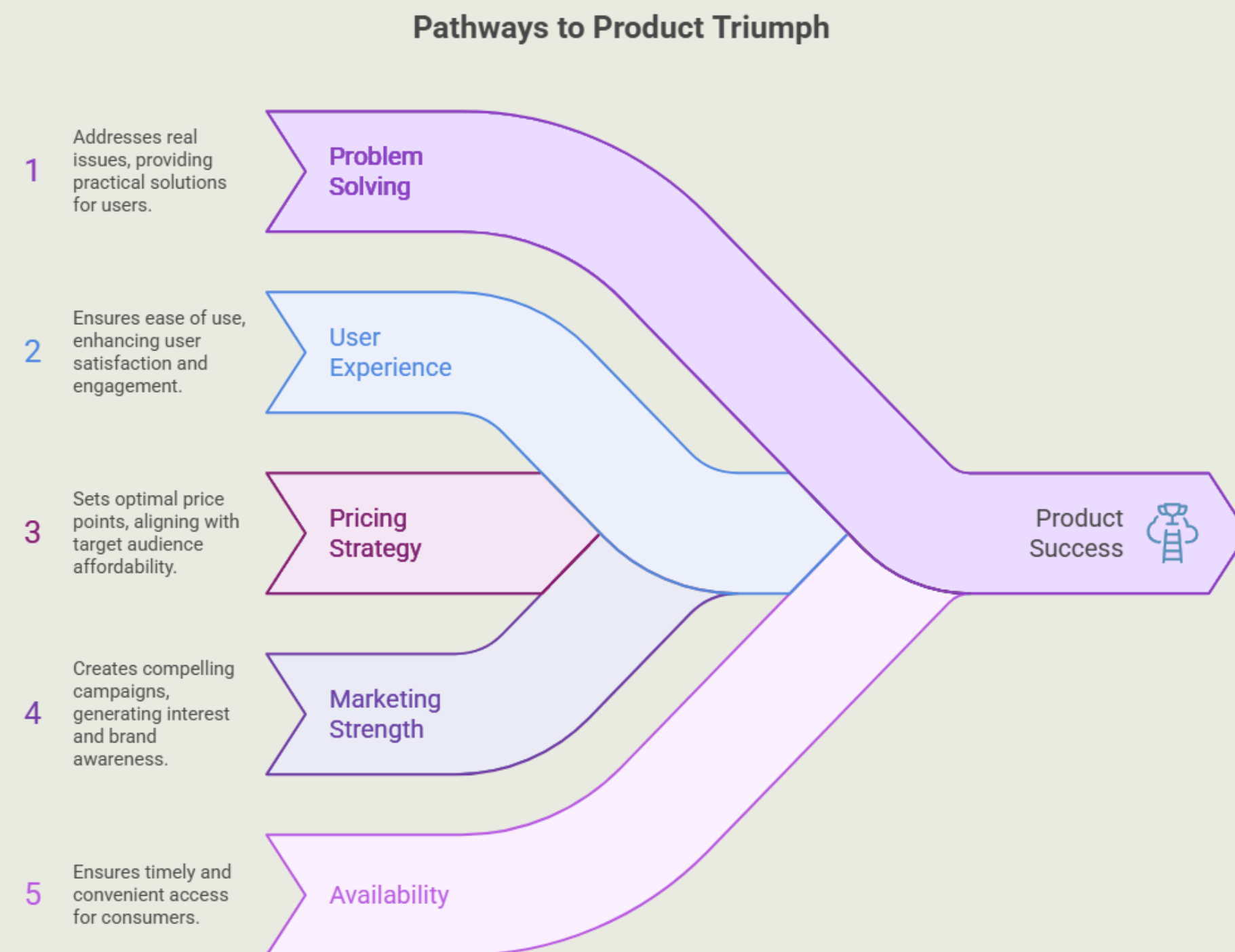
Customer: Valuable Vulnerable



Advanced and Specialized Types of Marketing



Product Success and Failure in Marketing



Product failure is often due to hidden factors.

Product Failure



Lack of Problem Solving



Poor User Understanding



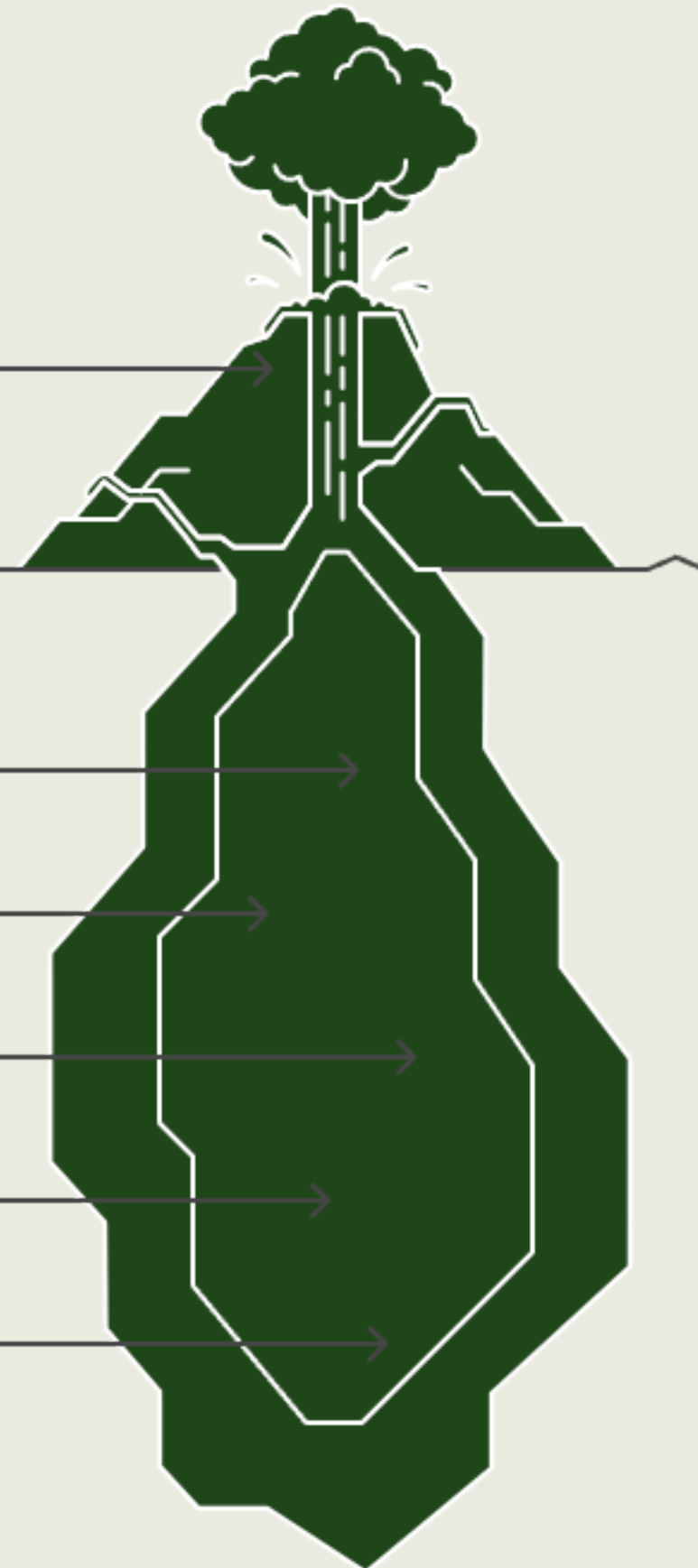
Pricing Issues



Ineffective Marketing

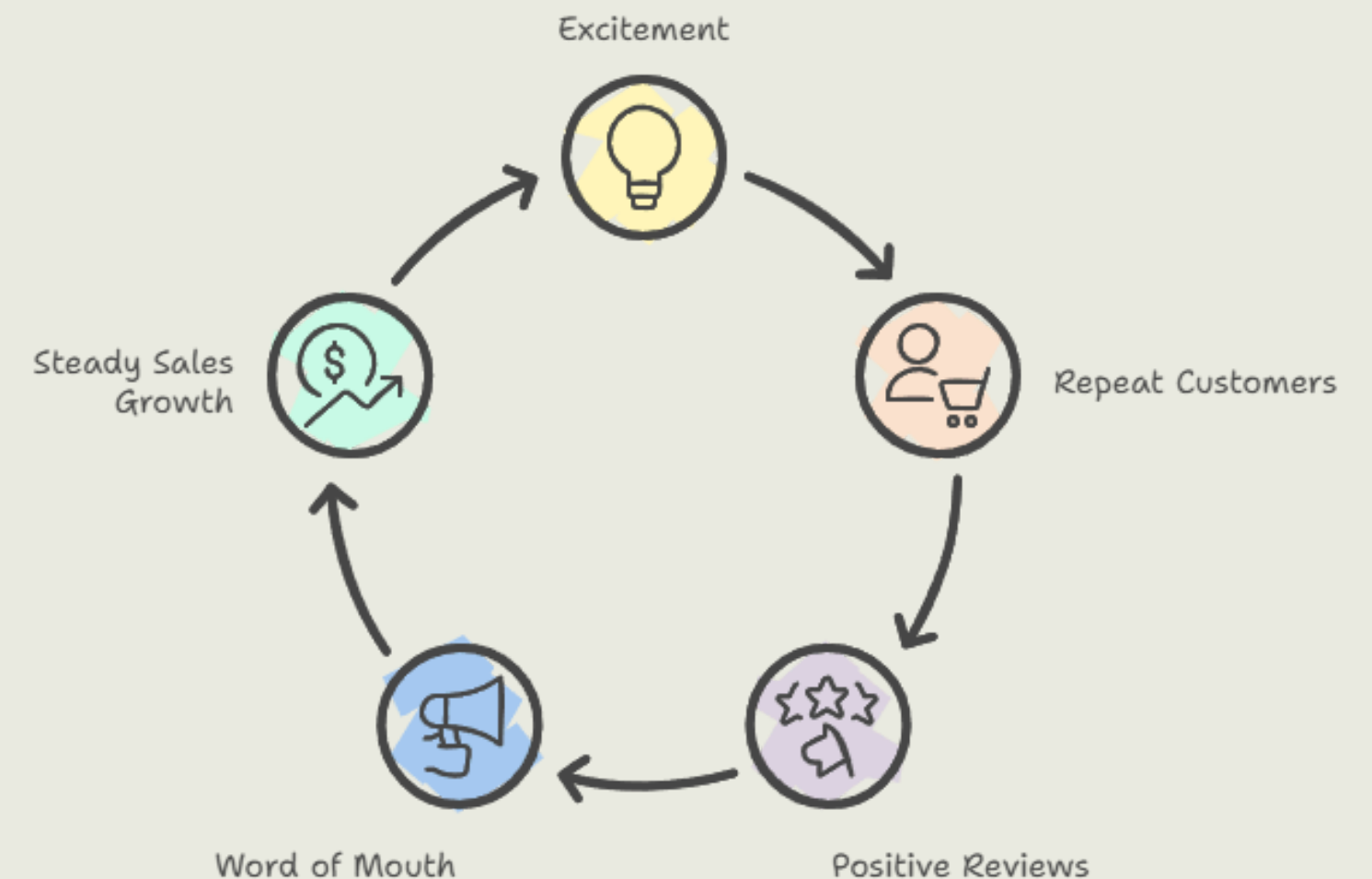


Launch Timing



Product-market fit

Product-market fit means your product is exactly what your target customers need. It happens when people like your product so much that they keep using it, talk about it, and even recommend it to others. It's a strong sign that your business idea works in the real world.



Lisners – Overview and Analysis

Overview:

Lisners is a mental health and wellness app developed by Brightlanes Technologies (Delhi, India, 2020). It connects users with mental health professionals via GDPR-compliant audio/video consultations, focusing on accessibility, privacy, and stigma reduction, particularly in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

Key Highlights:

Online therapy, career and relationship counseling, and peer community forums.

Freemium subscription model (₹500–₹1000/month for premium plans).

Target audience: College students (18–24 years) and young adults (25–35 years) in underserved regions.

Competitive edge: Focus on smaller cities, strong privacy measures, and holistic wellness tools.

Challenges Identified:

High marketing costs for a D2C model.

Limited brand awareness and competition from global mental health apps.

Need for stronger partnerships and user trust in smaller regions.

Root Cause:

While Lisners addresses a critical need for mental health services in underserved areas, its success is constrained by marketing challenges, competitive pressure, and the need for greater awareness among its target audience.

Link for the Docs: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1JIDbL8FCSxm902ZzRJbCiu1ZQS8L0RIM_NHB9KTnMNg/edit?tab=t.0

Netflix – Business Overview & Key Insights

Overview:

- Netflix, founded in 1997 by Reed Hastings and Marc Randolph, started as a DVD rental service and transitioned into a global video streaming platform in 2007. As of 2024, it has 277.6 million subscribers worldwide.

Key Statistics:

- Global subscribers grew from 21.5M in 2011 to 277.6M in 2024.
- Largest subscriber base: Europe, Middle East & Africa (93.9M), followed by US & Canada (84.1M).
- 30% of subscribers now use ad-supported plans introduced in 2023.
- Streaming service HQ: Los Gatos, California; key leaders include Ted Sarandos and Greg Peters (co-CEOs).

Challenges:

- Rising subscription costs have impacted perceived value among users.
- Strong competition as rivals replicate Netflix's streaming model.

Insight:

- Netflix remains a leader in streaming but faces the challenge of sustaining growth while maintaining affordability and content quality.

Link for the Docs: <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1G9zbeFb5wl-ndiJgwzMc7TItVMTCzBBsa4cb38O0MNg/edit?usp=sharing>

Problem-Solving Through Metrics

The content promotes **digging deeper into the data** to understand:

Why users aren't engaging (e.g., low Watch Start Rate or retention),

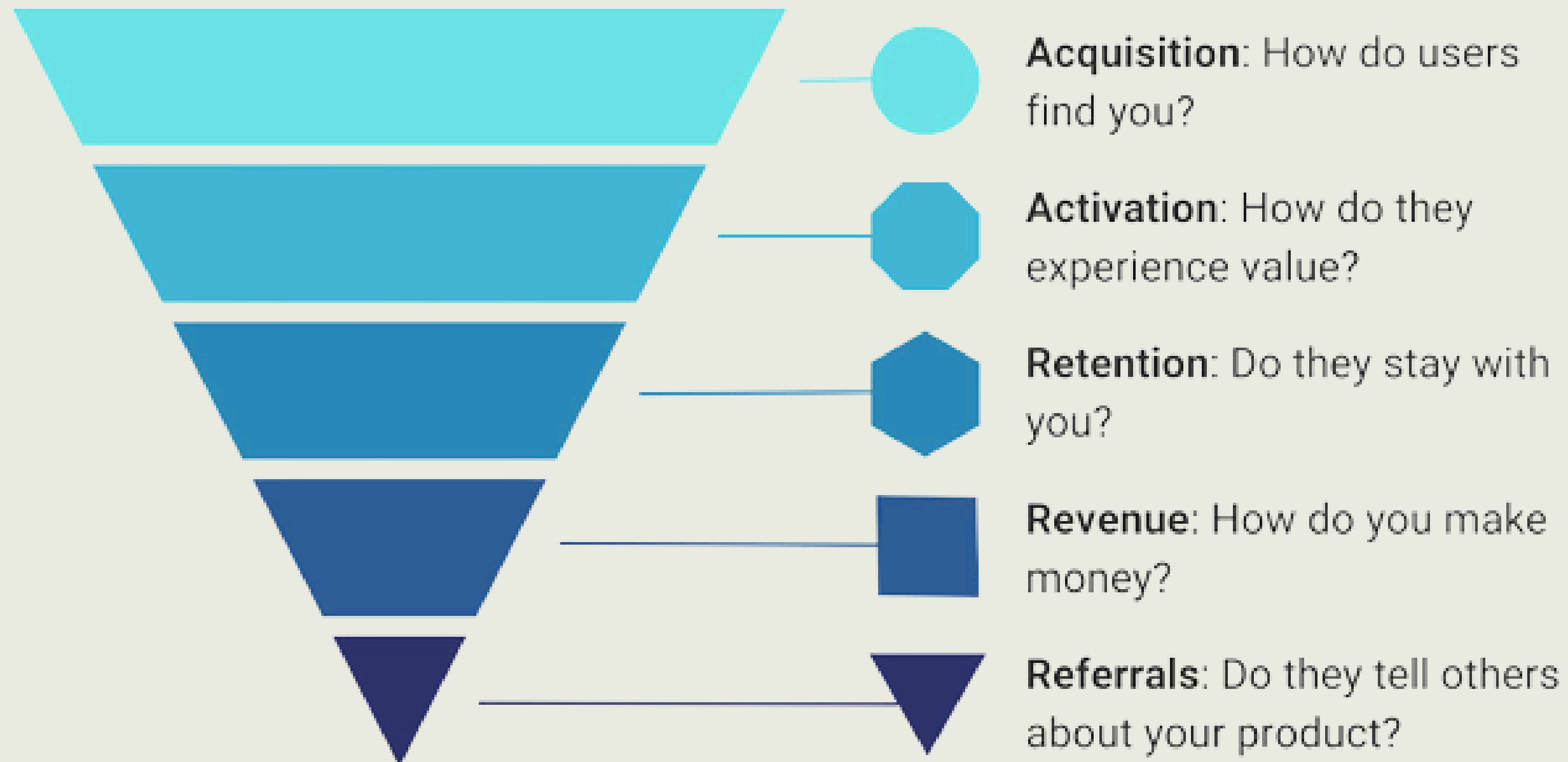
Where the funnel is breaking (AARRR framework),

What metrics signal deeper issues (DAU/MAU, churn, session length, etc.).

This is **RCA in action**: identifying a symptom (e.g., low retention), then analyzing data to uncover the **root issue** (e.g., poor onboarding or irrelevant content).

AARRR Framework (Pirate Metrics) as RCA Input

Each stage in AARRR can surface problems that demand RCA:





- Acquisition App Store downloads
- Activation Completing first lesson
- Retention Daily streaks
- Referral Share streak with friends
- Revenue Subscription upgrades

Stage	RCA Relevance
Acquisition	Why are users not downloading the app despite marketing spend?
Activation	Why are users dropping off before placing their first order?
Retention	Why aren't users coming back? (Churn reasons, onboarding gaps)
Referral	Why are users not referring the product?
Revenue	Why aren't users converting to paid subscriptions?

Example RCA Application:

Case: Zomato acquisition is high, but retention is falling.

PM Action: Run RCA by asking:

- What are the common traits of retained vs. churned users?
- Is the first-time experience confusing?
- Are notifications being ignored?
- Are there bugs affecting repeat usage?

Engagement Metrics as RCA Triggers

- A low DAU/MAU ratio may trigger RCA:
 - Are notifications irrelevant?
 - Is the app valuable enough for frequent use?
 - Are users facing friction in daily workflows?

DAU/MAU: What It Is and Why It Matters

Definitions

- **DAU = Daily Active Users**
 - The number of unique users who engage with your product at least once in a day.
- **MAU = Monthly Active Users**
 - The number of unique users who engage with your product at least once in a month.
- **DAU/MAU Ratio = $DAU \div MAU$**
 - A percentage indicating what portion of your monthly users are active daily. Often referred to as the stickiness ratio.

Why DAU/MAU Matters

Purpose	Description
User Engagement	Higher ratio → higher habit formation or utility.
RCA Trigger	A sudden drop signals a deeper engagement or value problem.
Growth Quality	Growing MAU without DAU growth? → Superficial adoption.
Experiment Evaluation	Useful for seeing the impact of new features or UX changes.

RCA Through DAU/MAU Example

Let's say:

- MAU is growing, but DAU remains flat.
- That means more people are trying your product, but not using it daily.

RCA Questions:

- Is onboarding bad? (users try once but don't return)
- Is value episodic, not daily? (e.g., flight booking app)
- Are daily use cases being blocked by bugs or complexity?
- Are notifications helping or annoying?

PM Action Framework (DAU/MAU-focused RCA)

1. **Track changes in DAU/MAU weekly/monthly**
2. **Segment users (by cohort, geography, device)**
3. **Identify which user group is:**
 - a. **Using app monthly but not daily**
 - b. **Was active but churned suddenly**
4. **Run user interviews to understand friction or dissatisfaction**
5. **Experiment with nudges, UX fixes, incentives**
6. **Measure DAU/MAU again → iterate.**

Quick Shot Prompts = RCA Scenarios

The “Quick Shot” sections ask hypothetical questions like:

“If one thumbnail gets more clicks but lower completion rates, which would you choose?”

Typical DAU/MAU Benchmarks

Product Type	DAU/MAU Ratio	Reason
Social Media (e.g., instagram)	50–70%	High habit-forming behavior
Messaging (e.g., WhatsApp)	60–80%	Daily communication need
E-commerce (e.g., Amazon)	15–30%	Event-based usage
Professional (e.g., LinkedIn)	10–20%	Occasional usage
Streaming (e.g., Spotify)	30–50%	Entertainment-based, depending on user patterns

How to Improve DAU/MAU Ratio

Strategy	How It Helps
Improve onboarding	Ensures new users understand and engage from Day 1
Smart notifications	Bring users back meaningfully without annoying them
Habit-forming hooks	Streaks, challenges, playlists, personalized recaps
Personalization	Tailored experience → more relevance → more use
Feature audits	Remove friction points that block repeat use

1. CIRCLES Method™ from Decode and Conquer

This is a structured framework for answering product design questions. It's very relevant to RCA because it helps dissect a problem systematically.

CIRCLES stands for:

- **C**omprehend the situation
- **I**dentify the customer
- **R**eport the customer's needs
- **C**ut through prioritizat
- **L**ist solutions
- **E**valuate trade-offs
- **S**ummarize your recommendation

This framework is **essentially RCA in design thinking form**, helping PMs identify **why a user pain exists** and how to solve it..

2. Metrics and Trade-Off Thinking

Example question from the reading:

“Your new feature boosts Amazon Search by 10%, but adds 2s to load time. What do you do?”

To resolve this:

- You investigate **what caused the slowdown** (i.e., do RCA),
- Measure **impact vs. downside**,
- Use metrics to weigh the trade-off.

Thank you.